



CONTACT

+27 828 244 145
nicolas.criticos98@gmail.com
Swartberg Karoo, South Africa
@niccris_samsara

SKILLS

- TECHNICAL
- > Solar system design & installation
 - > 3-phase & low-voltage electrical
 - > Arduino & automation
 - > Electronic circuit & PCB design
 - > Permaculture design
 - > Systems design
 - > Carpentry
- CREATIVE
- > Photography & videography
 - > Video editing
 - > Brand & website design
 - > Event organisation
- PERSONAL
- > Grade 7 pianist
 - > Ayurveda practitioner

REFERENCES

Andry Welihockyj
Owner, Vrisch Gewagt Olive Farm
andryrsa@gmail.com

Nikolas Cramer
Owner, Phakalane Retreat
CK78@protonmail.com
+27 640 284 620

Jack Manzevino
Solar System
+27 82 602 0653

NICOLAS CRITICOS

ECO-ENGINEER · REGENERATIVE FARMER · CREATIVE

+27 828 244 145 | nicolas.criticos98@gmail.com | Swartberg Karoo, SA | @niccris_samsara

Qualified electrical engineer with a deep commitment to sustainable living and regenerative agriculture. Combines technical engineering expertise with hands-on experience in permaculture, earthship construction, and organic farming. Currently leading the rehabilitation of 16,000 neglected olive trees in the Swartberg Karoo while managing a boutique guest farm and building a direct-to-consumer olive oil brand. Driven by the vision of building systems that leave land, people, and communities richer than they were found.

WORK EXPERIENCE

OLIVE TREE REHABILITATION LEAD2025 – Present

- VrischGewagt Boutique Olive Farm — Swartberg Karoo
- Leading the organic rehabilitation of ~16,000 olive trees across 40 irrigation blocks after years of neglect and drought
 - Restored irrigation infrastructure to pilot blocks (~1,500 trees), establishing replicable recovery methodology
 - Phased soil rehabilitation and pruning programmes aligned with seasonal growth cycles
 - Laid a 1.4km water pipeline for free flowing water to get from river to a dam
 - Building DTC olive oil brand via Instagram & WhatsApp

GUEST FARM MANAGER2025 – Present

- VrischGewagt Boutique Olive Farm — Swartberg Karoo
- Full operational management of guest accommodation, bookings, and visitor experience
 - Livestock management (sheep and cattle), property maintenance, and contractor coordination
 - Financial oversight of farm operations and seasonal planning

RETREAT MANAGER2024

- Phakalane Retreat — Cape Town
- Developed facilitator booking system for efficient guest-facilitator connections
 - Website optimisation and digital presence management
 - Staff and Guest management
 - Retreat organization and facilitation
 - Designed and built self-cleaning ice bath facility
 - Permaculture greenhouse design and construction

ENGINEERING WORK2022 – Present

- Engineered By Nature — Personal Company
- Designed and installed solar energy systems
 - Developed micro electronic systems and software solutions
 - Earthship construction (part of Biotonomy Academy programme)
 - AI Agent system development for business and personal

ART2023 – 2025

- Nicris — Personal Brand
- Art collaboration with Jake Michael Singer, constructing light sculptures
 - Film photography and art exhibition work
 - Model and Acting
 - Content creation
 - Creative Web Design

EDUCATION

B-ENG ELECTRICAL ENGINEERING (HONOURS)2017 – 2022

University of the Witwatersrand, Johannesburg
High voltage and low voltage specialisation. 3-phase electrical qualifications.

EARTHSHIP & SUSTAINABILITY DESIGN2023

Biotonomy Academy
Earthship design qualification.

AYURVEDA DOSHA BALANCING2024

Heal World